United States Special Operations Command (USSOCOM)

Justification and Approval (J&A) Document Template

Authority: FAR 13.106-1(b)(1) Only one source reasonably available, urgency, exclusive licensing agreements, brand

Type J&A: (Individual ☒ or Class ☐) Bridge Action: (Yes ☐ or No ☒) Greater than 12 Months: (Yes ☐ or No ☒)

Project/Program Name: H92277-25-Q-R011 [redacted]

Component/PEO/Other: SOTF-L, J4

Estimated Contract Cost (including options) : [redacted]

J&A No.

[redacted]

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Simplified Procedures for Sole Source Justification

1. Agency and Contracting Activity:

HQ USSOCOM-AO
7701 TAMPA POINT BLVD
MACDILL AFB, FL 33621

USSOCOM/SOF AT&L-KR
7701 TAMPA POINT BLVD
MACDILL, AFB, FL 33621

2. Description of Supplies/Services:

This request seeks approval to award a new firm-fixed price contract utilizing FY25 Operations and Maintenance (O&M) funds. The contract will procure critical unmanned aerial systems (UAS), components, accessories, and associated training [redacted]

3. Authority Cited:

FAR 13.106-1(b)(1):

☒ Brand-Name

4. Reason for Authority Cited:

Currently, the absence of dedicated Unmanned Aerial Systems (UAS) for cave clearing operations forces reliance on Military Working Dogs (MWD) or partner forces, significantly increasing risk to both personnel and mission success. This approach presents several challenges:

Hazardous Environments: Caves present confined, complex spaces with limited visibility and unpredictable terrain, increasing the danger to personnel and potentially hindering MWD effectiveness.

Specialized Threat Detection: Identifying hidden threats like explosives, booby traps, and concealed enemy combatants requires specialized equipment and expertise, limitations that UAS technology can address.

Communication and Coordination: Maintaining clear communication and coordination within a cave environment is crucial but challenging, potentially leading to delays and miscommunication.

To mitigate these risks and enhance operational effectiveness, we propose the acquisition and deployment of a dedicated UAS solution.

Enhanced Situational Awareness: FPV UAS provide real-time visual intelligence from within the cave, enabling operators to assess the environment, identify threats, and make informed decisions.

Reduced Risk to Personnel: Deploying UAS instead of personnel for initial reconnaissance and threat assessment significantly reduces the exposure of [redacted] and MWD teams to potential hazards.

Improved Communication and Coordination: UAS equipped with communication relays enhance coordination between teams inside and outside the cave, facilitating smoother operations and faster response times.

Estimated Cost: The estimated cost for this critical capability enhancement is [redacted] This investment will significantly improve the safety and efficiency of cave clearing operations, ultimately contributing to mission success and force protection.

[redacted] is requesting the training and accompanying training aids and equipment from [redacted] based on the requirements of the operating environment, expertise of the training vendor, and scope of training.

[redacted] has limited UAS capabilities and is reliant upon external agencies to provide specialized assets. This equipment enables ODAs to gain a visual on the risks present on an obscured objective, prior to engagement. Without this capability, ODAs accept undue to risk to the force by entering an objective without detect and defeat capabilities.

After conducting market research and a comprehensive and thorough review of available options, it has been determined that [redacted] is the only vendor that can provide the necessary training and accompanying training aids and equipment to meet the unique and specialized requirements of [redacted] operating environment. The [redacted] UAS platform presents a distinct combination of capabilities that make it the only viable solution for our specific needs.

[redacted] This heavy-lift capability, combined with its compact drone body, enables the system to operate effectively in confined spaces, such as those encountered in cave clearing operations. The system's First-Person View (FPV) guidance system provides real-time video feed, allowing for precise navigation and control, which is essential for safe and effective operation in complex environments.

In conclusion, [redacted] is the only responsible source capable of providing this requirement.

I have determined, in accordance with FAR 13.106-1(b)(1), that the circumstances of this contract action deem only a single source is reasonably available.

5. Technical and Requirements Certification:

I certify that the supporting data under my cognizance which are included in the justification are accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge and belief.

Name: [redacted] Title: [redacted]

Signature: [redacted] Date: Feb 13, 2025

6. Contracting Officer Certification:

I hereby certify that this J&A is complete and accurate to the best of my knowledge and belief.

Name: [redacted] Title: Contracting Officer

Signature: [redacted] by [redacted] Date: Feb 14, 2025